
Component 1: Drama

Overview

Students will study aspects of the form of drama via two plays. The central focus of the drama study is the literary text. Students will need to explore the use of literary and dramatic devices and the shaping of meanings in their chosen plays. Students study a tragedy or comedy drama by Shakespeare and another drama.

Teaching and wider reading should address the significance and influence of contextual factors and engage with different interpretations of the chosen Shakespeare play.

Students' study of Shakespeare should be enhanced by engagement with critical writing. Teaching of this is supported by either *Shakespeare: A Critical Anthology – Tragedy* or *Shakespeare: A Critical Anthology – Comedy*, provided by Pearson free of charge.

Learning outcomes

Students are required to:

- show knowledge and understanding of how playwrights use dramatic forms to shape meaning in drama texts and evoke responses in audiences
- show knowledge and understanding of the contexts in which texts have been produced and received and understanding of how these contexts influence meaning
- show knowledge and understanding of a range of ways to read and experience texts, responding critically and creatively
- respond to and evaluate texts, drawing on their understanding of interpretations by different readers such as literary critics
- identify and explore how attitudes and values are expressed in texts
- communicate fluently, accurately and effectively their knowledge, understanding and evaluation of texts
- use literary critical concepts and terminology with understanding and discrimination
- make appropriate use of the conventions of writing in literary studies, referring accurately and appropriately to texts and sources.

Content

Students will study aspects of the form of drama via **two plays, including one by Shakespeare and a second drama text.**

WILLIAM SHAKESPEARE

A choice of **one** text from the following:

Tragedy

Antony and Cleopatra, Hamlet, King Lear, Othello

Comedy

A Midsummer Night's Dream, Measure for Measure, The Taming of the Shrew, Twelfth Night

OTHER DRAMA

A choice of **one** text from the following.

pre-1900

- *Doctor Faustus*, Christopher Marlowe
- *The Duchess of Malfi*, John Webster
- *The Importance of Being Earnest*, Oscar Wilde
- *The Rover*, Aphra Behn

post-1900

- *Les Blancs*, Lorraine Hansberry
- *A Streetcar Named Desire*, Tennessee Williams
- *Sweat*, Lynn Nottage
- *Waiting for Godot*, Samuel Beckett

Critical writing

As part of their study of their selected Shakespeare play, students should engage with different interpretations. To support this, students should be provided with either the *Shakespeare: A Critical Anthology: Tragedy* or *Shakespeare: A Critical Anthology: Comedy*. Each critical anthology includes four generic essays and three specific essays on each set text to encourage students to engage with different readings of their studied Shakespeare play.

Each anthology fulfils all of the requirements for engagement with different perspectives for this component. **However**, centres are welcome to select other essays or criticism on their studied Shakespeare play or to supplement the critical anthologies with other critical materials on Shakespeare's drama.

Pre-1900 requirement

If a pre-1900 choice is not selected as the other drama play then it must be selected in *either* Component 2: Prose *or* Component 3: Poetry. Please see the *Qualification requirements* section on page 5 for more information on ensuring that this requirement has been met.